

Tochigi Prefectural Museum Website Renewal — Client Q&A; (English translation)

Translated from QA_result.pdf (29 items). For internal reference.

No.	Spec Ref / Section	Question (Bidder)	Answer (Client)
1	General	Can participants join the proposal review meeting online?	In-person (group) attendance only. Details will be notified separately to participants per Implementation Guidelines 5(2)i.
2	General	What is the scope of content to be migrated from the current site (all pages/PDFs/images/events/past notices, or only what the new sitemap needs)? Please also give approximate page/PDF/image counts.	In principle we expect the page structure in the spec's 'New Sitemap (draft)' to be newly built on the new server. However, for past museum-blog articles and special/themed-exhibition archives, if migration is possible within the contract price limit, please propose it.
3	General	Will the new site keep the current domain https://www.muse.pref.tochigi.lg.jp/ ? Please advise the prefecture vs. contractor split for DNS, subdomain, and SSL cert acquisition/renewal/installation.	As expected. The contractor should handle all of the above.
4	General	Is the use of royalty-free materials (photos/illustrations, commercial license) allowed?	Allowed, provided they become the prefecture's property as a deliverable of this project.
5	General	Is the use of AI-generated images/illustrations permitted?	Not permitted, because organizing rights matters such as intellectual property is difficult.
6	General	How much image/illustration material can you provide? And could you cooperate with a shoot by a photographer we arrange?	Materials currently on the museum website can basically be provided. Cooperation with shooting is also possible.
7	General	What success metrics/KPIs does the museum prioritize after renewal (monthly PV, page views, visit inducement, SNS spread, researcher/education access, etc.)? We'll reflect them in SEO/analytics/content design.	We use the museum website's access count and the museum's visitor count as indicators.
8	General	Are there operational pain points with the current site (update workload, inquiry frequency, page accessibility, etc.) we should reflect in the design?	In addition to those in spec item 1, low maintainability by staff is an issue.
9	General	Can you provide current-site analytics (monthly PV, popular pages, traffic sources, user attributes) as reference for the proposal?	After the contract is signed, we will grant the contractor view access to the current GA4. We will not provide individual analytics data (incl. PV) before signing.
10	General	The current site has the blog 'News' (1,000+), past special-exhibition pages (~137), themed-exhibition pages, and other archives. Is it correct that the new 'News'/'Special'/'Themed' categories are newly posted after renewal? Any requests on handling past archives (period migration, keeping old URLs)?	As expected. However, for past blog articles and special/themed-exhibition archives, if migration is possible within the contract price limit, please propose it.
11	Spec 12(1)No.14	What is the expected volume of additional content (pages/articles) from launch to contract expiry (Mar 31, 2027)? For that work, do you envision (1) contractor, (2) museum, or (3) combination?	The expected volume of additional content until contract expiry is undecided. The additional work is planned to be done by the museum.
12	Spec 5(1)g(iii)	For JIS X 8341-3, given the contract scale we plan Level A as the base with Level AA-equivalent care for key pages (top, usage guide, access). Do you have a different policy (all-page AA mandatory, third-party testing required)?	No problem.
13	Spec 5(1)g(iv)	For video-view measurement: are the target videos external embeds (e.g., YouTube) or files hosted directly on the site? If the number of videos, pages, and platform are decided, please advise.	No specific video plan at this point, but please implement the analytics setup.

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14	Spec 5(3) / Appendix 1	Does 'a server dedicated to the published website' include shared rental servers, or does it assume a site-dedicated VPS or cloud? If using a rental server, what matters (config, monitoring, backup, security) must be explained to the prefecture at proposal/contract time?	'A server dedicated to the published website' assumes an environment with independent resources and high security and stability. On that basis, propose a server that satisfies spec 5(2)-(4) and 10(1) for the matters requiring explanation to the prefecture.
15	Spec 5(3) / Appendix 1	For the pre-launch vulnerability audit and in-contract platform diagnostics (port scan, vulnerability check), please advise the assumed content, frequency, and level (automated tools vs. third-party), plus any required tools, report content, format, or items.	Self-diagnosis by the contractor using tools etc. is fine. Frequency: as stated in the spec, at least once during the contract period.
16	Spec 5(3) / Appendix 1	May we understand the contractor selects/contracts the server (rental/VPS/cloud)? Are there conditions on server form, mandatory security functions, domestic region, etc.?	As expected. Please select and contract a server that meets the spec requirements.
17	Spec 5(3)j	The guidelines list post-construction maintenance as reference expense (not in the fee), but the spec includes this year's server/maintenance cost in the fee. May we treat server/maintenance through Mar 31, 2027 as in the project cost, and from Apr 1, 2027 onward as reference expense?	As expected.
18	Spec 6	For pages other than those marked 'update function: yes' in the sitemap, must staff also update them via WordPress? Besides News / Special & Themed Exhibitions / Events, are update functions needed for staff intro, publications, FAQ, application forms?	If implementing CMS for other pages contributes to the project's purpose, please propose it.
19	Spec 6	Is any CMS other than WordPress not allowed? If others are possible, please advise.	As stated at the start of spec item 6 (CMS requirements), it shall be WordPress.
20	Spec 7	What is the required SEO work scope: keyword research, SEO design, and Google Search Console setup/verification — or also analysis reports and improvement proposals?	Up to keyword research, SEO design, and Google Search Console setup and operation verification.
21	Spec 8(2)a	May we understand the multilingual (EN / Traditional & Simplified Chinese) requirement assumes the browser's built-in translation, requiring a translation-friendly structure, and that the contractor does NOT create EN/Chinese versions? And that existing English pages are abolished at launch (old URLs kept as-is / no redirect)?	As expected.
22	Spec 8(2)c	What is the scope of 'manuscript rewriting'? Is it organizing headings, unifying notation, and plain-Japanese adjustment of existing copy — or does it also include new manuscript creation, interviews, and content verification?	New manuscript creation, interviews, and content verification are included in the contractor's work.
23	Spec 8(2)e	Please advise the reservation system to be continued (service name and integration method). Will any separate cost arise from using the current system?	The reservation system is AirRESERVE. We envision continued use via link setup. No cost will arise.
24	Spec 10(1)e	For the 1-year free defect response after operation start: does this 1 year also apply after the contract period ends? And is the free scope limited to deliverable defects/spec non-conformance, with WordPress core/plugin/server updates and normal maintenance under a separate maintenance contract?	As expected.
25	Spec 10(1)e	Please indicate your policy on who bears the infrastructure costs (server, SSL, etc.) needed for the 1-year post-contract defect response.	We will judge individually and specifically after isolating the cause of each incident.
26	Appendix 2	For the Google/Yahoo!/SNS/video ads in Appendix 2, do you envision ad delivery or ad-account operation within this project? And what is the contractor's scope for GA, GSC, and GTM (setup, operation support, analysis reports)?	No ad delivery or ad-account operation is planned. For GA, GSC, and GTM we envision up to setup and operation support.
27	Sitemap (draft)	The sitemap says 'aggregate links to the museum blog and various SNS'. Does this mean all articles will be posted to News?	If there is something besides posting to News that contributes to the project's purpose, please propose it.

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28	Sitemap (draft)	For special/themed-exhibition special pages we plan one common template. Is individual design per exhibition required, or is there an assumed number of special pages per year within this project?	Using a common template is fine.
29	Sitemap (draft) - Collection	For the collection database (separate domain digitalmuseum.pref.tochigi.lg.jp), we plan an external link from the new site. Do you require extra handling such as an in-site search form or API data fetch?	An external link is fine.